

Welcome to **Music City Data User Group**

Nashville's SQL Server & Microsoft Data Platform Community

Thursday, September 3, 2026 · Tonight's Speaker: Matt Gordon



Tonight's Agenda

- **5:30 - 6:00 Networking, Food & Drinks**
Grab a seat, meet fellow data pros
- **6:00 - 6:15 Welcome & Announcements**
Community updates
- **6:15 - 7:15 Presentation**
Highlights and Hidden Gems in SQL Server 2025
- **7:15 - 7:30 Questions & Networking**
Wrap up conversations before you head out

Thank You to Our
Host & Sponsor

Vaco by Highspring

5501 Virginia Way, Suite 120 · Brentwood, TN

Thank you for the space, refreshments, and community support!

What is MC-DUG?

Music City Data Users Group

Nashville's community for data professionals focused on SQL Server & the Microsoft Data Platform.

Who it's for: DBAs · Developers · Data Engineers · Analysts · Architects · Anyone learning data

Topics: SQL Server & Azure SQL · T-SQL & Performance · PowerShell & Automation · Data Engineering & Warehousing · Career Growth

Come for the data. Stay for the community.

Meet the Organizers

Jason Romans — Lead Organizer

Microsoft MVP based in Nashville, focused on Microsoft Fabric, Power BI & data modeling.

Blog: datashepherd.dev (The Data Shepherd)

Kevin Kline — Co-Organizer

Microsoft Data Platform MVP for 20+ years; Founder & former President of PASS.

Also known for: Co-author, SQL in a Nutshell (O'Reilly)

Two organizers. One growing Nashville data community.

Where to Find Us

- ▶ **Our Home**

musiccitydata.org (redirects to Meetup)

- ▶ **Join on Meetup**

meetup.com/music-city-data-user-group

- ▶ **Want to Speak?**

sessionize.com/musiccitydata

- ▶ **Contact**

organizers@musiccitydata.org

Stay Connected

- ▶ **Meetup** — The main place for upcoming meetings & activities
Check Meetup for the next session, RSVPs, and announcements
- ▶ **Email** — Reach the organizers anytime
organizers@musiccitydata.org
- ▶ **GitHub** —
Mainly for slides: **slides.musiccitydata.org**
Code of Conduct: **conduct.musiccitydata.org**

Code of Conduct

We're all here to learn and grow together.

Please keep things:

- **Respectful** — treat everyone with courtesy
- **Professional** — keep discussions constructive
- **Inclusive** — everyone belongs here
- **No spam or solicitation**

Full Code of Conduct:

conduct.musiccitydata.org

Other Microsoft Communities in Nashville

Check their Meetup pages for upcoming sessions:

- ▶ **Nashville Power BI User Group**

meetup.com/nashville-modern-excel-user-group

- ▶ **Nashville Microsoft Azure Users Group**

meetup.com/the-nashville-microsoft-azure-users-group

- ▶ **Nashville .NET User Group**

meetup.com/nashdotnet

More Nashville Data Communities

More Nashville data communities to follow:

- ▶ **Microsoft 365 Users Group of Nashville & Knoxville**

meetup.com/m365usergroup

- ▶ **Nashville Data Nerds**

meetup.com/data-nerds

New Speakers Welcome!



Interested in presenting but haven't done it before?
We'd love to help you get started. Here are some easy ways to ease in:

- ▶ **Lightning Talks** — 5–10 minutes on a tip, tool, or lesson learned
- ▶ **Short Session Before the Main Talk** — A 15–20 min opener to warm up the room
- ▶ **Full Presentation** — When you're ready for the full stage

No experience needed — just a willingness to share!
Submit at sessionize.com/musiccitydata

New Certification Alert: DP-800

Microsoft just launched a new certification for SQL pros diving into AI:

- ▶ **Microsoft Certified: SQL AI Developer Associate** — Microsoft's newest cert, GA since May 2026
- ▶ **What it covers** — T-SQL AI functions, vector embeddings, semantic search & RAG
- ▶ **Where it applies** — SQL Server, Azure SQL & Fabric SQL databases
- ▶ **Free cert offer** — Join [Fabric Data Days 2026](#) for a free cert

Learn more — learn.microsoft.com/credentials/certifications/developing-ai-enabled-database-solutions

A great next step after T-SQL.

Upcoming Events

Mark your calendars for these free community data conferences:

Nashville Microsoft Community Day

Friday, September 11 · Nelson Andrews Leadership Center

Day of Data Salt Lake City

Saturday, September 19 · Neumont University

Day of Data St. Louis

Saturday, October 24 · Microsoft Technology Center

Next Meeting - Wednesday, Oct 7

Tony Wilhelm

TBD

Wednesday, October 7, 2026 · 5:30 PM

Vaco by Highspring · Brentwood, TN

RSVP at musiccitydata.org once listed

Our Meeting Cadence

We're settling into a monthly rhythm at Vaco:

- **Wednesday, Oct 7 — Tony Wilhelm - TBD**
- **Tuesday, Nov 3 — Speaker TBD**
- **Tuesday, Dec 1 — Speaker TBD**

Want one of the open slots? Talk to an organizer tonight or email organizers@musiccitydata.org

Get the Slides



slides.musiccitydata.org



Hosted on **GitHub**

Presentation decks may be available if not hosted by speaker

All slides are open and freely available

About Matt Gordon

- ▶ Director of Data & Analytics at Lean TECHniques and a Microsoft Data Platform MVP
- ▶ Data professional, speaker, and community presenter with a passion for SQL Server and the Microsoft data platform

NOW

Matt Gordon

Highlights and Hidden Gems in SQL Server 2025

*SELECT * FROM community*